

More cloud music

Reports suggest Apple has signed Warner Music in preparation for its upcoming streaming iTunes service

Where's the million?

Facebook calls user a 'spammer'. User sues Facebook for \$1. Shouldn't it be \$1 million ?!

HTC Desire Z

When Z means a keypad

The Desire was one of HTC's most popular models that faced criticism on account of its plastic body and the lack of a dedicated keypad. The Desire Z addresses both these shortcomings, and although this section of the Android market is a lot busier than during the Desire days, the Desire Z stands out as a well-rounded device.

Built of metal with plastic bits, the Desire Z is heavy, at 180 grams, and has a rather plain silver and grey colour scheme. The QWERTY keypad doesn't slide out, rather it has a hinge system that reveals the keypad when lifted – we question the longevity of this mechanism. The S-LCD first seen on the Desire makes a comeback, although the menu keys are capacitive-touch

this time, with uneven lighting that detracts from the quality feel of the handset. The on-screen keypad is sensitive, but in portrait mode you will find it a bit cramped.

The hardware QWERTY also deserves mention for the wrong reasons – keys are small, feedback is hard and rubbery and the layout isn't the best we've seen – as a result it's not very usable, and we found the onscreen keypad in landscape mode to be a better bet.

Reception and call clarity tests are a breeze, as is handsfree and loudspeaker volume, although the latter is too tinny for music. The Desire Z has a very nice camera, although its only 5 MP; it produces crisp images with good colour and very decent highlighting. The phone is quick enough, but at times



we found it a bit sluggish compared to a Desire HD that runs faster hardware. Battery life is decent.

Our major gripe with the Desire Z would be its flawed QWERTY keypad. Other than that, it's a good phone, although for the price there are newer handsets around. With dual cores on the way, we're also beginning to wonder about future proofing. With the release of handsets like the Incredible S, the Desire Z with its flawed keypad loses a good bit of its charm.

Michael Browne

Specifications

Display: 3.7-inches, 480 x 800 pixels; OS: Android 2.2; SoC: Qualcomm MSM 7230; RAM: 512 MB; memory expansion: microSD; battery: 1300 mAh; Weight: 180 grams

Contact

Bright Point India

Phone: 9910821100

Email: nitin.pandita@brightpoint.com

Web site: www.htc.com/in

Price: ₹25,590

7.0
10

Features.....	7.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	7.5
Value for money	7.0

Specifications

display size: 17-inches, resolution: 1920 x 1080 pixels; CPU: Core i5 480M; RAM: 4 GB DDR3 1333 MHz; GPU: Radeon HD 5850M; HDD: 640 GB, 7,200 rpm; Weight: 3.41 kgs

Contact

HP India Pvt. Ltd.

Phone: 1-800-425-4999

Web site: www.hp.com

Price: ₹93,550 + tax (MRP)

7.0
10

Features.....	7.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build.....	7.0
Value for money	5.5

HP Envy 3D 17

Owners Envy, or owners pride?

The 17-inch, 3D-ready Envy is HP's answer to the Alienware threat. While large, and heavy, the Envy is attractive, and imbued with liberal doses of metal. The inside also has metal, and is satin-finished, not glossy – a relief, although the display is reflection prone. The keypad is

well spaced out and the keys nice, the trackpad is reasonably sensitive, though for gaming, you'd be daft not to consider a mouse.

3D support is at hand, and glasses are bundled, and it works well on the bundled demo content with good colour, and depth being salient highlights, unlike some 3D TVs we've seen that fail. However, we couldn't get 3D working on the games.

Hardcore gamers will want to get more than 27.16 fps in Crysis Warhead (1280 x 1024, no AA), though at 51.6 fps in Call Of Pripyat at identical settings in

DX11 mode. Certainly it's more than up for most popular online games like World Of Warcraft and Counterstrike. Note that the HD 5850 gets very hot, with temperatures crossing 90 degrees when gaming, particularly if the venting holes are blocked, if it were to be used on a soft surface.

The price tag of ₹93,550 plus taxes is a high one to pay even for a gaming setup that boasts of 3D viewing. While the Envy isn't exactly great value for money, or the best performing notebook out there, it is the cheapest 3D-capable notebook at the moment.

Michael Browne

